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CLIMATE



GM teams up with  
Redwood Materials to  
power data centers with  
EV batteries

GM is sending new and old EV batteries to recycler Redwood Materials, which then repurposes the packs for stationary energy storage, the two companies announced today.

Second, their work will megawatts of energy. The installation center will

The new storage facility focuses on energy storage. The found the facilities

Rather than recycle the embedded materials, the company kept the packs intact, then connected them to create a large energy storage system that can store excess electricity, often generated by solar and wind, for later use. The batteries for the Crusoe project are fed by solar panels.

“I think this has the potential to grow faster than the core recycling business,” Redwood co-founder and CEO JB Straubel said at the time. Redwood already recovers around 70% of all used or discarded batteries in the U.S. The company plans to deploy 20 gigawatt-hours of energy storage by 2028.

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Redwood isn't the only company following that playbook, though its ability to integrate a variety of packs — from different manufacturers and chemistries — could give it an edge over competitors.

Both GM and Redwood have an existing agreement, but the new collaboration marks an expansion.

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One notable detail: GM's willingness to supply Redwood with new batteries, not just old ones, gives it a hedge against uneven growth in EV sales. New sales dipped 6.3% in the second quarter of this year, according to Cox Automotive, though they're expected to surge before tax credits are phased out September 30.

Energy storage, on the other hand, has been growing consistently in recent years. New installations in the first quarter of this year hit a new record, up 57% year-over-year.

Topics: [battery pack](#) [battery recycling](#) [Climate](#)

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Redwood Materials launches energy storage business and its first target is AI data centers

Tucked between two massive buildings in the hills of the Nevada desert, 805 retired EV batteries lie in neat formation, each one wrapped in nondescript white tarps — and hiding in plain sight.

A passerby might not realize the unassuming array is the largest retired EV battery storage facility in North America that'll

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The new business, called Redwood Energy, is kicking off with partner Crusoe, a startup Straubel invested in 2021. The old EVs, which are not yet ready for recycling, store energy generated from an adjacent solar array. The system, which generates 12 MW of power and has 63 MWh of capacity, sends power to a modular data center built by Crusoe, a company best known for its large-scale data center campus in Abilene, Texas — the initial site of the Stargate project.

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IMAGE CREDITS: REDWOOD MATERIALS

The scale of Redwood's battery-collection operation is staggering — and an opportunity. Redwood said it recovers more than 70% of all used

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ticket now and save up to \$675 before prices rise on August 7.

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Straubel's confidence in the endeavor was apparent in every detail of the launch event. To illustrate the commitment of Redwood — and by extension, Straubel — everything at the event, from the music and projection on the big screen to a laser light show that included giant Pac-Man ghosts navigating the rows of EV batteries, was powered

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"We wanted to go all in," Straubel said, breaking into a wide, toothy smile. Splashy effects for the event aside, the microgrid setup with Crusoe is not a demonstration project. Straubel said this is a revenue-generating operation, which was constructed in four months, and one that is profitable. He added that even more of these will be deployed with other customers this year.

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supplies those back to Panasonic and other customers. Over time, the company has expanded beyond recycling and into cathode production. Redwood generated \$200 million in revenue in 2024, much of which comes from the sale of battery materials.

The company has expanded beyond recycling and into cathode production. Redwood has located a new facility in Michigan, near GM's state-of-the-art battery factory.

Redwood isn't tied to any one company. It's a retired battery manufacturer that's moved into solar, and the Crucible

"There's no green intent required here," CTO Colin Campbell said during a tour of the microgrid. "It's a good economic choice that also happens to be carbon-free."

The business model addresses a long-standing challenge in the energy storage sector. For over a decade, companies have been promising to build grid-scale storage from used EV batteries, but they've only materialized in small amounts. Redwood, which got its start as a battery materials and recycling company, is creating a new line that

promises to deliver gigawatts of much needed energy storage in just a few years.

“This really demonstrates how economical the waste hierarchy actually is,” Jessica Dunn, a battery expert at the Union of Concerned Scientists, told TechCrunch. That a large recycler like Redwood recognized the profit potential in repurposed EV batteries shows “where this end-of-life market will go,” she added.

Repurposing batteries is a clear business opportunity for Redwood, but it might also be a business imperative. Redwood was founded to build a supply chain that could handle the predicted

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Straube that in many ways Redwood Materials started a bit early.

“We started really early, and in a way we started Redwood almost too early,” he said, noting the company initially was collecting consumer batteries and production scrap ahead of the coming wave of EVs.

The current state of the recycling market underscores the challenge. “Right now, the recycling market is mostly manufacturing scrap, consumer electronics, and EV batteries that have failed under warranty,” Dunn said. That has been

enough for Redwood to process over 20 gigawatt-hours annually. But it pales in comparison to the 350 gigawatt-hours in EVs today and the 150 gigawatt-hours expected to hit the road every year.

Redwood currently has a recycling facility at its 175-acre campus in Sparks, Nevada, and it's developing a [600-acre facility](#) in Charleston, South Carolina. The latter will remanufacture cathode and anode copper foil, both of which contain critical minerals that the U.S. would prefer stayed within its borders.

The company previously said that it will be capable of making 100 gigawatt-hours annually of cathode active material and anode foil by the end of this

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Senior Reporter, Climate |

Tim De Chant is a senior climate reporter at TechCrunch. He has written for a wide range of publications, including...

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Redwood Materials is setting up shop near the Tesla Gigafactory as part

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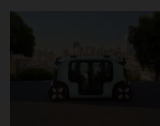
Redwood Materials, the battery recycling startup founded by former Tesla CTO JB Straubel, has purchased 100 acres of land near the Gigafactory that Panasonic operates with Tesla in Sparks, Nevada as part of an expansion plan that aligns with the Biden Administration's drive to increase adoption of electric vehicles and boost domestic battery recycling and supply chain efforts.

The company said Monday that its existing 150,000-square-foot facility in Carson City, Nevada will also nearly triple in size. Redwood is adding another 400,000 square feet onto the Carson City recycling

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Kirsten Korosec

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facility, which is expected to be operational by the end of the year.

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As part of its growth plans, Redwood is also hiring hundreds of workers. The company, which is backed by Amazon, employs 130 people today and expects to add more than 500 jobs over the next two years.

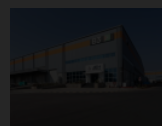
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Plan will unlock massive opportunities for US businesses as it spurs innovation and demand for technologies—like vehicle batteries and battery storage—creating clean energy jobs for all.”

Redwood Materials, which was founded in 2017, is trying to create a circular supply chain. The company has a business-to-business strategy, recycling the scrap from battery cell production as well as consumer electronics like cell phone batteries, laptop computers, power tools, power banks, scooters and electric bicycles. Redwood collects the scrap from consumer electronics companies and battery cell manufacturers like

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Panasonic. It then processes these discarded goods, extracting materials like cobalt, nickel and lithium that are typically mined, and then supplies those back to Panasonic and other customers. The aim is to create a closed loop system that will ultimately help reduce the cost of batteries and offset the need for mining.

Redwood Materials has a number of customers, and has only publicly disclosed that it is working with Panasonic, Amazon and AESC Envision in Tennessee

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Redwood Materials says it recovers about 95% to 98% of the elements from the batteries such as nickel, cobalt, lithium and copper. Today, it receives 3 gigawatt-hours annually, a figure that the company says is equivalent to about 45,000 cars.

# Why Amazon and Panasonic are betting on this battery recycling startup



JB Straubel, the Tesla co-founder and former CTO, is often cast as the humble and pioneering engineer, the quiet one who toiled away in the background for 15 years on some of the company's most important technologies. That characterization — which intensified as the hype and media attention on Tesla CEO Elon Musk grew — ... Continue reading

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